Yuvaraj Gopalan

Engineering Manager · Technical Program & Delivery Manager · Quality Engineering Leader

Leipzig, Germany · Available immediately · Open to relocation: Germany, Europe, Gulf, India, Singapore, Malaysia

LinkedIn | GitHub | yuvarajleip@gmail.com

24+ years in quality engineering

14 direct reports managed

350+ REST APIs validated in CI/CD

7 Agile teams under quality ownership

ABOUT

I help software teams ship products they can trust. Over 24+ years across SAP, cybersecurity SaaS, telecom and IoT my work has moved from hands-on testing to leading people and delivery. I have managed distributed teams (up to 14 direct reports, including vendor resources), covering hiring, one-to-ones, goal setting, performance reviews, performance improvement plans and development plans, run Agile and Kanban delivery, and set quality strategy that holds up in practice, with AI-assisted engineering where it helps.

I am looking for engineering manager, QA test manager, team lead and delivery or program manager roles, with a focus on managing and mentoring teams, setting quality strategy and owning delivery, with technical oversight rather than day-to-day coding. Germany first; open to Europe and the Gulf.

EXPERIENCE

08/2026 – 11/2026

Freelance Project Manager & Test Automation Consultant

Freelance · Salesforce automation for two international clients (India and the UK)

- Managed delivery: planned and scheduled work, tracked effort and progress, and reported status to stakeholders and clients.
- Delivered a Playwright/TypeScript framework (Page Object Model, self-healing) with 345 end-to-end tests, and Python API automation with 40 API tests.
- Built a Python test data framework (NumPy, Pandas, Pydantic) that creates validated records on demand and respects Salesforce validation and duplicate rules.

Playwright · TypeScript · Python · Salesforce · Pandas · Pydantic

07/2025 – 07/2026

Project Manager | Automation Architect

ACL Digital, Bengaluru, India · Cisco Smart Spaces (IoT and location-intelligence platform)

- Owned automation architecture: extended the existing Playwright (Python, Robot Framework) framework with new modules and test suites, and built a new Playwright TypeScript framework with POM for stability and faster execution.
- Created self-healing automation; built Auto-Heal and a Smart Automation Report.
- Set up Jenkins CI/CD validation for the engine, UI and API.
- Built AI-assisted validation across requirements, code, APIs and CI/CD evidence; trained 40 people on internal AI tools (Copilot and Codex).

Playwright · Python · Robot Framework · TypeScript · Codex · Copilot · Sauce Labs · Jenkins

02/2023 – 06/2025

Engineering Manager

Swimlane (SOAR security-automation SaaS), Hyderabad, India

- Led the Technical Integrations team: 14 direct reports (8 engineers, 6 vendor resources) delivering several hundred third-party integrations (connectors) for the Turbine platform, plus the content library, external marketplace and customer-facing solution workflows.
- Full people-management responsibility: hiring (job descriptions, working with recruiting agencies and HR on candidate profiles), goal setting, regular one-to-ones, coaching and development plans; ran performance reviews and performance improvement plans (PIPs), handled compensation discussions and employee separations.
- Customer success: delivered integrations for customer needs, joined customer calls and stakeholder updates, and handled escalations and incidents with Support, Product and Engineering.
- Introduced AI-driven connector development: connector development coverage from 20% to 80% in six months.
- Led automated validation of 350+ REST APIs in CI/CD pipelines; directed the JMeter performance-testing framework for enterprise rollouts.

07/2014 – 02/2023

Senior Quality Specialist (Senior Principal Engineer)

SAP Labs, Bengaluru, India · S/4HANA, SuccessFactors, Fiori/UI5

- Quality accountability for seven Agile Scrum teams (six automation engineers); ~1,380 automated tests covering 1,700 scenarios.
- Automated S/4HANA and Fiori/UI5 tests with Tosca (2 years), Selenium and Cypress; mobile testing on Sauce Labs.
- Triage Manager for four years (SuccessFactors Compensation, Employee Central, Analytics); handled customer escalations.
- QA for a nine-application SAP Fiori suite (Australian Department of Education programme, Daikin Japan).
- Invited SAP d-kom speaker presenting SuccessFactors Reward and Recognition to 118 customers and partners.

02/2010 – 07/2014

Lead Software Engineer

Syniverse Technologies · telecom OSS/BSS

- Led QA for telecom messaging and BSS billing platforms (interconnect billing, settlement, XDR/CDR usage-to-billing validation).
- Functional, database, integration and performance testing with Selenium, TestNG, LoadRunner and JMeter.

12/2005 – 02/2010

Lead Engineer, Quality Assurance

VeriSign, Bangalore, India

- Led a QA team for telecom value-added services; built Selenium/TestNG frameworks; coordinated testing across India and the US; member of the Security Validation team.

11/2004 – 12/2005

Quality Assurance Engineer

bebo Technologies, Chandigarh, India

- Functional, manual and database testing of enterprise business-process workflows.

05/2002 – 10/2004

Software Test Engineer

Perichin InfoServ, Chennai, India

- Functional and database testing of Human Capital Management recruitment-lifecycle workflows.

RECOMMENDATIONS

> “He managed a full team of engineers in the development of several hundred third-party integrations for the Turbine platform. In addition, he also managed the development and delivery of our content library, external marketplace, and several customer facing solution workflows. He consistently worked very collaboratively with his team, and with other globally distributed teams. […] Yuvaraj was a great partner to work with and would make a great manager for any engineering team.”
>
> — Swimlane colleague, LinkedIn recommendation

> “Yuvaraj led our Technical Integrations team with exceptional focus and expertise. Yuvaraj consistently demonstrated strong leadership, clear communication, and a deep understanding of complex integration challenges. […] I highly recommend Yuvaraj for any Engineering Manager role—he would be a tremendous asset to any organization.”
>
> — Swimlane colleague, LinkedIn recommendation

> “Yuvaraj stood out as a people-first leader who truly prioritized team well-being and growth. He was always approachable, created a safe space for open discussion, and ensured we had the clarity and support needed to deliver. His strength lay in removing roadblocks, aligning stakeholders, and fostering a positive, collaborative environment where engineers could focus and thrive.”
>
> — Swimlane team member, LinkedIn recommendation

> “Yuvaraj was my manager during my initial months at Swimlane, and I highly recommend him as a manager. He is incredibly supportive and empowering, always encouraging me to take on new challenges and develop my skills. […] I grew significantly under his guidance.”
>
> — Swimlane team member, LinkedIn recommendation

INDEPENDENT PROJECT

Qualinexus – AI-assisted test automation platform (prototype)

- Takes existing test cases (CSV, Excel, Jira or typed requirements) and turns them into automated tests
- Generates positive, negative, boundary and regression cases and the Playwright scripts
- Runs on Chrome, Firefox and WebKit and reports results per requirement
- Asks for clarification when a requirement is too vague to test
- Self-heals when the UI changes: finds the new locator, reruns the test and waits for human approval before applying the fix
- Generates schema-validated test data
- Early prototype demonstrated on a sample store with synthetic data; no customers yet

SKILLS

Leadership & delivery

Engineering management · Team leadership (up to 14 reports) · Project & program delivery · Agile / Kanban · Stakeholder reporting · Risk & escalation management · Jira (15 yrs) · SAP Cloud ALM (3 yrs)

Test automation

Playwright – Python, Robot Framework, TypeScript, POM (2 yrs) · Selenium (5) · Cypress (1) · Robot Framework (2) · TestNG (5) · Tosca (2) · Salesforce test automation · Self-healing automation · Sauce Labs mobile testing

AI-assisted engineering

LLM-assisted test authoring & debugging · RAG, MCP / tool-calling (prototype) · GitHub Copilot · Codex · Windsurf · AI-assisted validation

APIs, data & performance

REST / OData (5) · Postman (5) · JMeter (3) · SQL (10) · Test data management (Pandas, Pydantic)

Languages & DevOps

Python (5) · Java (5) · TypeScript (1) · Jenkins (5) · GitHub Actions (1) · Docker (1) · Kubernetes (1)

Enterprise platforms

SAP S/4HANA (6) · Fiori / UI5 (6) · SuccessFactors · Salesforce · Telecom OSS/BSS · Cybersecurity SaaS · IoT

Numbers in brackets are years of hands-on use.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree, Computer Science
Bharathidasan University, Tiruchirappalli, India · 2000 – 2002

LANGUAGES

English (C1) · Tamil (native) · German (A1, learning)

References available on request. Last updated November 2026.